

Chickpea Tachin With Herb Salad

March 23, 2026

Recipe information

Total Time 2 hours

Yield 4–6 servings

Ingredients

½ tsp. saffron (15–20 threads)

3 medium onions, thinly sliced, divided

2½ cups (lightly packed) mixed tender herb leaves with tender stems (such as parsley, dill, cilantro, and/or mint), divided

9 Tbsp. extra-virgin olive oil, divided

2 tsp. ground coriander

2 tsp. ground cumin

2 tsp. vegetable or chicken bouillon paste (such as Better Than Bouillon)

½ tsp. freshly ground pepper, plus more

½ tsp. Diamond Crystal or Morton kosher salt, plus more

1 15-oz. can chickpeas, rinsed

½ cup dried tart cherries or unsweetened dried cranberries

2 cups basmati rice, rinsed

2 large egg yolks

¼ cup mayonnaise

1¼ cups whole-milk Greek yogurt, divided

Preparation

Step 1

Place a rack in middle of oven and preheat to 425°. Combine **½ tsp. saffron (15–20 threads)** and **1 Tbsp. warm water** in a large bowl; set aside.

Step 2

Meanwhile, place about **½ cup thinly sliced medium onion** in a medium bowl of ice water and set aside to soak. Finely chop **1¼ cups (lightly packed) mixed tender herb leaves with tender stems (such as parsley, dill, cilantro, and/or mint)** and set aside.

Step 3

Heat **5 Tbsp. extra-virgin olive oil** in a large skillet over medium. Add **2 tsp. ground coriander, 2 tsp. ground cumin, 2 tsp. vegetable or chicken bouillon paste, ½ tsp. freshly ground pepper, ¼ tsp. Diamond Crystal or Morton kosher salt**, and remaining onions and cook, stirring often, until onions are deep brown and crisp in spots, 13–17 minutes.

Step 4

Add **one 15-oz. can chickpeas, rinsed**, to pan; increase heat to medium-high. Cook, stirring occasionally, until slightly crisped, 6–8 minutes. Remove from heat; mix in **½ cup dried tart cherries or unsweetened dried cranberries** and reserved chopped herbs. Season with more salt and pepper if needed.

Step 5

Cook **2 cups basmati rice, rinsed**, in a medium saucepan of boiling generously salted water until just al dente, about 5 minutes, then drain.

Step 6

Add **2 large egg yolks, ¼ cup mayonnaise, ¾ cup whole-milk Greek yogurt**, and **¼ tsp. Diamond Crystal or Morton kosher salt** to reserved bowl with saffron; whisk until smooth. Fold in rice.

Step 7

Pour **3 Tbsp. extra-virgin olive oil** into an 8x8" glass baking dish and spread around to coat bottom and sides. Add 2 cups rice mixture and press with a flat-bottomed measuring cup or a spatula to compress. Mound onion mixture over, leaving a ½" border on all sides, and flatten slightly. Spoon remaining rice mixture on top and lightly press down to compress. Cover baking dish with foil.

Step 8

Bake tacin until bottom and sides are deep golden, 55–65 minutes. Let cool 10 minutes, then remove foil and run a paring knife around sides to loosen. Place a platter or large plate upside down over baking dish and hold together as you quickly turn over; remove baking dish.

Step 9

Whisk remaining **½ cup whole-milk Greek yogurt** and **2 Tbsp. water** in a small bowl (it should be thin enough to drizzle; add more water if needed). Season with salt and pepper.

Step 10

Drain reserved onion. Toss onion, a **pinch of kosher salt**, remaining **1¼ cups (lightly packed) mixed tender herb leaves with tender stems**, and remaining **1 Tbsp. extra-virgin olive oil** in same bowl to combine. Mound salad on top of tachin; serve with yogurt sauce.

Tags	Main	dinner	Vegetarian	Nut Free	Oven Bake	Spring	Persian	
	Middle Eastern	Saffron	Herbs & Spices	Parsley	Dill	Cilantro	Mint	Chickpea
	Bean and Legume	Vegetable	Dried Cherry	Dried Fruit	Fruit	Dried Cranberry	Rice	
	Rice & Grains	Yogurt	Dairy	Bon Appétit				